



2026 E-Rate Deadlines Checklist (FY2026)

Milestone	Key Date / Rule
Form 470 window opens	July 1, 2025
28-Day Rule	Post Form 470 at least 28 days before Form 471
Form 471 window closes	May 29, 2026
PIA review response	Within 15 business days of request
FCDL issued	Spring / Summer 2026
Category 1 invoice deadline	October 28, 2027 (120 days after FY end)
Category 2 invoice deadline	October 28, 2027 (120 days after delivery)

Filing Checklist

- ☐ File Form 470 and post for competitive bidding (28+ days).
- ☐ Evaluate bids using a scoring matrix; pick the most cost-effective vendor.
- ☐ File Form 471 before the window closes (May 29, 2026).
- ☐ Respond to any PIA review within 15 business days.
- ☐ Review your FCDL; appeal denials within 60 days if needed.
- ☐ File Form 486 after services start.
- ☐ Submit invoices (BEAR/SPI) before the October 28, 2027 deadline.

Need a hand hitting every deadline? Call (855) 765-7291 or email admin@erateapp.com. 25+ years of E-Rate experience.
erateapp - SkyRate LLC, 30 N Gould St Ste N, Sheridan, WY 82801. Dates per USAC; confirm on usac.org.